CHARACTERISTICS OF EFFECTIVE COLLEGE WRITING	*4 – Exemplary*	*3 - Proficient*	*2 – Basic*	*1-Not Demonstrated*
GRAMMAR	Writing is error-free.	Some grammatical errors exist, but they do not seriously detract from meaning.	Writing has many grammatical errors that detract from meaning.	Writing has so many grammatical errors as to be virtually unreadable.
SPELLING	Writing is error-free.	Some spelling errors exist, but they do not seriously detract from meaning.	Writing has many spelling errors that detract from meaning.	Writing has so many spelling errors as to be virtually unreadable.
SENTENCE STRUCTURE	Sentences are varied and grammatically correct.	Sentences have few grammatical errors, but could have been more varied and interesting.	Sentences are simple and lack variety. A number of grammatical mistakes are present.	Sentences are unclear and many grammatical errors in structure make paper unreadable.
WORD CHOICE VOCABULARY Word choice and vocabulary show clear understanding of course content.	Word choice and vocabulary show an exceptional understanding of course content. Word choice is well matched to the subject and audience.	Some understanding of course content is shown. Word choice and vocabulary are acceptable.	Word choice and vocabulary do not clearly express ideas or address the assignment.	Word choice and vocabulary are vague and unclear.
CONTENT Content of paper addresses assignment.	Paper has clear thesis that thoroughly and insightfully addresses all aspects of the assignment. All parts of paper support thesis and clearly and accurately make case.	Paper has thesis that addresses assignment. Some parts of paper could have more thoroughly supported thesis.	Paper has incomplete or ill-defined thesis, and does not completely address the assignment. Content sometimes strays from the assigned topic.	Paper has no clear thesis and does not address the assignment.
ORGANIZATION Paper is organized and readable; has distinct introduction, body, and conclusion	Paper is interesting and readable. It has a distinct introduction that grabs the reader's attention; a body that clearly addresses all main points; and a conclusion that ties paper together. Paragraphs flow together with smooth transitions.	Paper is readable and has an introduction, a body, and a conclusion. Some points could have used stronger support, and stronger transitions could have helped paper have better flow.	Paper has limited readability and an inadequate introduction, body, and/or conclusion. Transitions are lacking, and paper is difficult to understand.	Paper is disorganized, has no introduction, body, or conclusion. Work needs to be reorganized and re-done.
EVIDENCE OF CRITICAL THINKING Paper presents creative solutions, applications , or predictions, beyond the obvious.	Writer develops logical and reasoned independent ideas that go beyond predictable outcomes or the conclusions of researched materials.	Ideas are logical and reasoned, but demonstrate lesser degree of originality.	Writing is primarily opinion without valid support. Little critical thinking is evident.	Paper lacks evidence of critical thinking.
CITATIONS Paper uses APA style.	Writer uses correctly the APA Style for the citations throughout and bibliography.	Writer uses correctly the APA Style for the bibliography but incorrectly for a few citations.	Writer uses incorrectly the APA Style for the bibliography and citations.	APA Style is not used for the bibliography and citations.
Total	**32**	**24**	**16**	**8**